Scoring Matrix:

Voluntary and Work Experience — Scoring Criteria

Assessment criterion: The extent to which applicants have used university holidays productively through paid employment, professional placements, entrepreneurial ventures, or voluntary work.

Score	Description of achievement
1 – Exceptional	Demonstrates outstanding commitment, leadership, or measurable impact. Examples include completing a placement lasting more than six weeks at a prestigious firm; taking a leading role in a voluntary organisation and making a substantial contribution beyond usual expectations; establishing a business with a strong record of success; or undertaking several high-level work placements with demonstrable outcomes.
2 – Strong	Shows considerable initiative through activities such as an extended placement (over six weeks) at a highly competitive organisation, substantial charitable or fundraising contributions, or founding a business.
3 – Moderate	Has made effective use of university breaks through sustained employment, a summer job lasting more than eight weeks, a charity-based project exceeding four weeks, or a range of shorter work or voluntary commitments.
4 – Limited	Provides little evidence of sustained engagement in employment or voluntary work. Activities may be sporadic or minimal, with few identifiable achievements or outcomes beyond participation itself.

Bonus: +1 point

No Evidence of impact.

Leadership — Scoring Criteria

Assessment criterion: Evidence of leadership ability, effective organisation, strong communication, and the capacity to motivate others and deliver meaningful results.

Score	Description of achievement
1 – Exceptional	Holds a prominent leadership position with significant responsibility and demonstrable impact. Examples include serving as a university-wide Students' Union officer, college Students' Union or JCR president, president of a major university society, captain of a university first team in a major sport, director or conductor of a music or drama group, editor of a university publication, or leading the organisation of a major ball or large-scale event.
2 – Strong	Demonstrates substantial leadership at university or college level, such as serving as a college Students' Union or JCR officer, captaining a university team in a less prominent sport, leading a major sporting team within a college or department, holding an officer position in a major university society, or editing a college or departmental publication.

3 – Moderate	Has taken on smaller-scale leadership responsibilities, including presiding over a minor university or college society, serving as an officer in a smaller society, captaining a college team in a less prominent sport, organising a major event, or holding an officer role in a ball or other significant event.
4 – Limited	Has little or no demonstrated experience of leading others, coordinating activities, or organising people and events.

Additional scoring adjustments

- **-1 point:** Multiple achievements within the same scoring band that demonstrate significant impact and merit additional recognition.
- **+1 point:** No clear evidence of achievement or tangible impact beyond a description of the role or activities undertaken.

Excellence and Accomplishment — Scoring Criteria

Assessment criterion: The level of dedication, success, and demonstrable impact shown through individual or team-based achievements across sport, the arts, debating, publications, and extracurricular activities.

Score	Description of achievement
1 – Exceptional	Demonstrates outstanding ability or success in a significant field. Examples include competing in a major sport at university, county, or national level; performing a leading role in music or drama, such as a soloist at a major concert or the lead in a theatrical production; making a substantial contribution to a university society or Students' Union beyond simply holding a position; winning a debating competition; publishing a book; or achieving distinction in another comparable area.
2 – Strong	Shows considerable accomplishment in extracurricular pursuits, such as participating in a less prominent sport or competing at college or departmental level in a major sport; performing in university-level music or drama; representing the university in debating; holding a choral scholarship; or making a significant contribution to a society or Students' Union through achievements rather than an official title.
3 – Moderate	Demonstrates consistent participation in one or two extracurricular activities, such as team sports, music, drama, or university societies. Contributions may also include writing articles or other material for a student newspaper, magazine, or publication.
4 – Limited	Provides little evidence of notable achievements beyond school, with limited participation or success in extracurricular activities at university level.

Additional scoring adjustment

- **−1 point:** Multiple achievements within the same scoring band that demonstrate substantial impact and warrant additional recognition.

Clarify the scoring direction